

PERIPHERALS GAMING MICE

If you need headshots, accuracy shouldn't be a compromise

For everyday usage, you wouldn't bother whether your mouse is accurate or not. Competitive gameplay is where you start taking these things seriously. We wanted to find the gaming mouse that was not only accurate but also gave the best overall performance in tracking. And this year, we included a wireless gaming mouse as well. The winners here may not have the best features or build quality, but they offer the best sensor performance among the gaming mice that we tested and were launched this year.

2017 ZERO1 AWARD WINNER ASUS ROG Strix Impact

Last year, our tests found the PMW3310 sensor to have incredible sensor performance present on several mice that arrived in our labs. The SteelSeries Rival 300 and Zowie mice including EC2-A, FK2 and ZA11, were the ones with the 3310 that we tested last year and most of them are still superior to the Strix Impact. This year, only the ASUS ROG Strix Impact and the HyperX Pulsefire FPS sported the 3310. Despite having the same sensor, there was a considerable difference in performance between the two. The Strix Impact performed well in the Enotus



ASUS ROG Strix Impact
Price: ₹4,800



Logitech G603
Price: ₹ 5,995



Cooler Master MasterMouse Lite S
Price: ₹1,500

Mouse Test and generated smooth graphs in the MouseTester test. Although it didn't score the highest among all the mouse we've tested from the previous year, it has earned a place among them. There were no spin outs or acceleration observed in the mouse, and there was no visible jitter in cursor movement. All of these earned the Strix Impact the Zero1 Award.

RUNNER-UP Logitech G603

The debate on whether wireless peripherals, wireless mice in this case, match up to their wired counterparts for gaming has been going on for a few years. We can say that they haven't yet surpassed wired mice, but the Logitech G603 performed even better than some wired gaming mice. With some surprisingly brilliant scores in the Enotus Mouse Test, and decent performance in MouseTester, the new HERO sensor from Logitech proves to be a good sensor for gaming. There's still work to be done in the sensor when it comes to maintaining a stable polling rate. We observed random drops in tracking while running MouseTester. This can either be a power efficiency implementation to save battery or an error in the sensor itself. Nonetheless, the mouse never stopped tracking and these drops in tracking weren't visible during regular usage even while gaming. For now, we can certainly say that for casual and even hardcore gaming, you can opt for the G603 but there's still work to be done to earn the respect of competitive gamers.

BEST BUY Cooler Master MasterMouse Lite S

Buying a budget mouse for gaming means you have to compromise on performance, features, and build quality. There are mice being sold at dirt cheap prices but they are literally unplayable, even for casual games. They always tend to spin out at fast swipes or display acceleration as well. There are a few mice that don't spin out and can be used to casually play FPS games. Cooler Master's MasterMouse range of gaming mice has three variants in different price brackets where the entry-level mouse - Lite S - is a decent choice for gaming. However, it has a high lift-off distance and does display positive acceleration and angle snapping. But if you want to casually game and not be irritated with your crosshair spinning out or experience random pixel jumping, the MasterMouse Lite S is a good choice. It's an entry-level gaming mouse with minimal features and good build quality. 